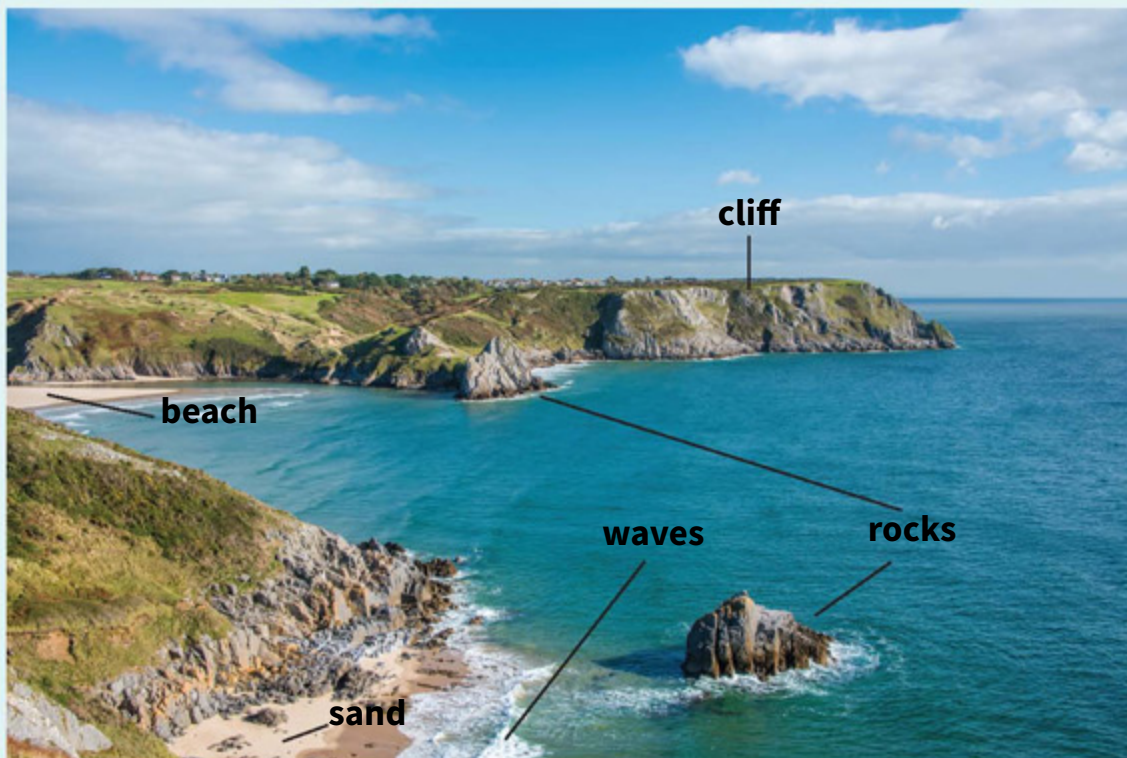


A

The beach



Many people **spend** their holiday at the **coast** [the land close to the sea], where there are a lot of **seaside resorts** [towns by the sea for tourists] and they can go to the beach every day. Generally people prefer beaches that are **sandy** [with lots of sand], where you can go for a **stroll** [a casual walk] along the **shore** [the place where the sea meets the land] in the **sunshine** [when it is sunny]. On the beach, you also sometimes get a **breeze** [a nice gentle wind] that blows off the sea.

B

Beach activities



surfing



windsurfing



diving



playing volleyball



sunbathing

Volleyball is a popular beach game and some people enjoy water sports such as **surfing**, **windsurfing** or **diving**. If the sea is **calm**¹, you can **go for a swim**, but a lot of people just want to lie on the beach and **sunbathe** and get a nice **(sun)tan**². However, there are now worries about the dangers of **sunbathing**. People who lie in the sun without any **protection**³ can get **sunburn**⁴, and worse still, they are **at risk of**⁵ getting skin cancer. Doctors now **recommend**⁶ that people do not sit in the sun without using **sunscreen**⁷. It may be safer just to sit in the **shade**⁸.

¹ without waves (does not move very much); *opp* rough

² when the skin becomes brown

³ something to keep someone safe

⁴ when the skin becomes red and very sore

⁵ if you are at risk of something, there is a danger that something bad may happen to you

⁶ say what someone should do

⁷ cream that gives protection from the sun; *syns* **sunblock, sun cream**

⁸ an area where there is no light from the sun, so it is darker and less hot

Language help

We can **go for a walk**, a **drive** (a journey in the car for pleasure), a **swim**, a **coffee** [drink some coffee], a **drink** (often an alcoholic drink, e.g. wine, beer). We can also **have a swim**, a **coffee**, a **drink**.

We **went for a drive** along the coast. I **had a coffee** at Caffé Nero. Let's **go for a drink** tonight.

Exercises

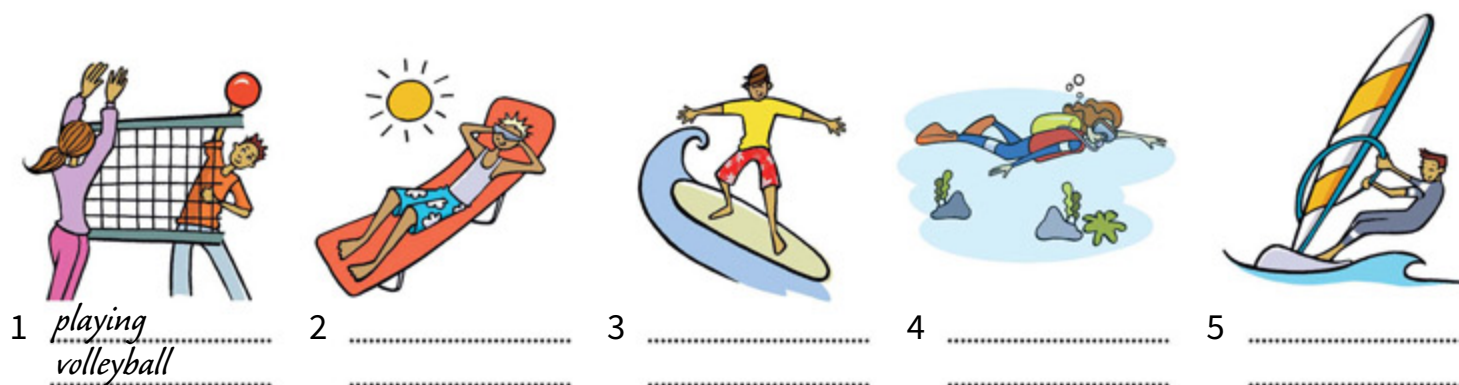
51.1 Write down four more words beginning with *sun*.

sun *shine* sun _____ sun _____ sun _____ sun _____

51.2 Match the words on the left with the words on the right.

- | | | |
|--------------|--------------------------|-----------|
| 1 sun | ☐ | a shade |
| 2 wind | ☐ | b sea |
| 3 seaside | ☐ | c surfing |
| 4 sit in the | ☐ | d tan |
| 5 sandy | ☐ | e resort |
| 6 rough | ☐ | f beach |

51.3 Cover the opposite page. What are these people doing?



51.4 Cross out the wrong answer.

- | | | | | |
|-----------------|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------|---------------|
| 1 The beach was | a lovely | b calm | c sandy | d dirty |
| 2 We went for a | a drive | b shop | c drink | d stroll |
| 3 The sea was | a sandy | b calm | c rough | d cold |
| 4 I enjoy | a surfing | b diving | c getting sunburn | d windsurfing |
| 5 We walked | a along the beach | b by the shore | c on the waves | d on the sand |
| 6 The beach was | a near the cliffs | b by the breeze | c by the rocks | d very sandy |

51.5 Complete the sentences.

- I love sunbathing, so I can get a nice *suntan* _____.
- Doctors _____ that you stay out of the sun completely in the middle of the day.
- We used to sunbathe for hours, but then we didn't know we were at _____ of getting skin cancer.
- I always take a beach umbrella to give me _____ from the sun when it is very hot.
- In the city it feels like there's no air, but you often get a nice _____ by the sea.
- I love going for a _____ along the beach, especially in the evening when it's quiet.
- I don't like sitting in the sun; I prefer to sit in the _____.
- We decided to _____ a swim before lunch.

51.6 Over to you

Answer the questions. If possible, ask someone else the same questions.

- Do you ever spend time at seaside resorts? Where do you go, and how often?
- Do you enjoy any of the beach activities on the opposite page? Which ones?
- Do you like sunbathing? Why? / Why not?
- Do you get a suntan easily? Have you ever had sunburn? Do you often use sunscreen?
- What do you like to do in the evening after a day on the beach?